

LAB 2 PROMPT CARD

Meeting Notes to a Controlled Excel Action Register

Use Copilot Chat to extract a field-level delta, approve it, and update only the authorised cells in Excel.

CORE RULE: For an existing action, change only the field explicitly changed in the meeting. Preserve every other value exactly as it appears in Excel.

1. Ground the comparison

Turn on Work IQ. Reference the supplied Project Atlas meeting-notes document and the Project Atlas Action Register workbook. Confirm that Copilot can name both sources before asking it to compare them.

Source check

Use only the referenced Project Atlas meeting notes and Action Register.

Before analysing them, name both sources and tell me which Excel sheet contains the current master actions. If either source is unavailable, stop and tell me.

What to inspect

Confirm the meeting date, the workbook sheet name, the action-ID format and the current values in each matched row. Do not rely on a meeting summary alone when the source notes are available.

2. Extract and compare field by field

Field-level comparison

Compare the meeting notes with the existing Action Register field by field.

First, match each relevant statement to an existing Action ID.

For an existing action:

- Read the complete current Excel row.
- Identify only fields explicitly changed during the meeting.
- Create one proposed-change row for each changed field.
- Include the current Excel value and the proposed meeting value.
- Preserve every field that was not explicitly changed.
- Do not regenerate or replace the complete action row.
- Do not replace existing values with blank, Not confirmed or inferred values.
- If the new value equals the current value, classify it as NO_CHANGE.
- If information conflicts, classify it as HOLD.

For information that does not match an existing action:

- Determine whether it is a confirmed new action.
- Use ADD_ACTION only when the task, owner and required values are sufficiently clear.

Return: Change ID, Action ID, Classification, Field to change, Current value, Proposed value, Exact evidence, Missing or conflicting information, Human decision.

Allowed classifications: UPDATE_FIELD, ADD_ACTION, NO_CHANGE, DUPLICATE, HOLD and NOT_AN_ACTION.

3. Review before editing

Copy the proposed changes into the Field Change Queue and New Action Queue. Approve, reject or hold each row. One action may have several proposed field changes, and each field must be approved independently.

Exception review
Review the proposed queues before any workbook edit. Flag: 1. A proposed change whose current value does not match Excel 2. A field change not supported by exact meeting evidence 3. A changed owner or deadline inferred rather than confirmed 4. A conflict that should remain HOLD 5. A suggestion converted into an action 6. A proposed full-row replacement for an existing action Do not edit the workbook. Return only the exceptions and the clarification question needed for each one.

Human approval gate

Use Approved only when the exact field, current value, proposed value and evidence are correct. Use Hold when any required detail conflicts or is missing. Reject suggestions and false matches.

4. Apply only approved changes

Plan, then edit in Excel

Use the approved Field Change Queue and New Action Queue to update the Action Register.

Rules:

- Apply only rows where Human Decision is Approved.
- For UPDATE_FIELD, change only the named field in the specified Action ID.
- Preserve every other cell in that row exactly as it is.
- For ADD_ACTION, create one complete new row and assign the next sequential Action ID.
- Do not apply HOLD, DUPLICATE, NO_CHANGE, NOT_AN_ACTION or Rejected rows.
- Do not rewrite existing rows.
- Preserve formulas, formatting, validation and table structure.

Before editing, show Action ID, exact field, current value and new value. Wait for confirmation before applying the changes.

5. Audit every changed cell

Before-and-after audit

Audit the updated Action Register against the approved queues.

List every changed cell. For each changed cell show Action ID, field, previous value, current value and matching approved Change ID.

Flag:

- Any changed cell without an approved Change ID
- Any approved change that was not applied
- Any unchanged field that was accidentally modified
- Any complete existing row that was replaced
- Duplicate Action IDs or missing required values

Do not make further edits.

Fallback: If Excel Edit mode is unavailable, keep Copilot's output in the Review Queues and apply approved changes manually, one field at a time.

Microsoft references: support.microsoft.com/en-us/excel/copilot/frequently-asked-questions-about-copilot-in-excel | support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/refer-to-specific-files-and-more-in-microsoft-copilot